

OKLAHOMA SCHOOL TESTING PROGRAM

TEST BLUEPRINT AND ITEM SPECIFICATIONS

GRADE 7 ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS



OKLAHOMA
Education

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

The Book Fair



- 1 Our school holds an annual book fair each January, where new and used books are available for students to purchase. Our librarian, Mr. Egan, is the school sponsor for it. Traditionally, the seventh grade students are responsible for the planning, set-up, and selling at the fair. I am sure that Mr. Egan consulted our teacher, Ms. Cates, for suggestions as to who would be the student directors, and I was pleasantly surprised when he approached me to be one of the students in charge. I was even more surprised when he told me that the student I would be working with was Charlie Lyons.
- 2 Charlie and I have known each other since kindergarten but have never been close. Ever since we were designated partners for the science project last year, there is very little we choose to say to each other. Needless to say, the science project fell short of our expectations. I know that we both had our individual ideas and strategies about the direction the project would go, but we just found it difficult to work together. In light of that event, I was dumbfounded that Mr. Egan and Ms. Cates found us a suitable match.
- 3 At the initial meeting with Mr. Egan, we divided the responsibilities between us. I would be in charge of setting up the room and getting the volunteers to work the sale for all three days. Charlie would be in charge of all the books. We were both quite satisfied with our jobs, and even more satisfied that there would be little contact between us.

- 4 I left the meeting and immediately started thinking of what I needed to do. With only two weeks to plan, I knew I could not procrastinate.¹ I enlisted John, Mark, Kaylee, and Rachel to help me with the set-up and twelve other classmates to work at the fair. I figured that, between Mr. Egan, the friends who volunteered to help, and me, we would be just fine. My mom and Kaylee's mom volunteered to help out, too. They would give us more adult supervision in case any unforeseeable problems occurred.
- 5 The second meeting among Mr. Egan, Charlie, and me was scheduled for exactly one week before the fair was scheduled to open. Charlie was absent that day, and I anticipated that Mr. Egan would postpone the meeting for another day. He said that he would meet with me anyway because he had a librarian's conference to attend the next two days. Mr. Egan said he would be in touch with Charlie when he returned from the conference. He asked about how my preparations were going, and I provided him with a detailed report. He seemed satisfied and said he would see me at the set-up.
- 6 I tried on two separate occasions to initiate a conversation with Charlie about the progress he was making, but each time his response was, "Everything's cool."
- 7 On the day of the set-up, my friends and I arrived, only to find Charlie with his head in his hands, surrounded by a zillion boxes of books. I asked him, "Charlie, what's wrong?"
- 8 He responded, "I think I've got a problem. There are a lot more books here than I anticipated. I thought I could do it all by myself. I'm up a creek without a paddle. Will you help me?"
- 9 My initial impulse was to say, "No, this is your mess. Figure it out." But instead I responded, "Sure, Charlie. Let me see if I can get some people to lend us a hand."
- 10 All in all, the book fair was a success, but I would have preferred not to have the last-minute panic situation that we did.
- 11 After the book fair was over, I could not stop wondering what Mr. Egan was thinking when he put us together, so I asked him. His reply was quite simple, "You see, I knew that this would be a great experience for both of you. It wasn't so much about running the book fair as it was a lesson in how important it is to communicate and to work alongside others when necessary."
- 12 I think he accomplished his goal.

¹**procrastinate:** to put off doing something

1 Which characteristic of the passage shows that it is fiction?

- A** It is the correct length.
- B** It uses descriptive language.
- C** It has a conflict and a resolution.
- D** It takes place in more than one setting.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

7.2.R.2: Students will analyze details in fiction, poetry, and nonfiction texts to distinguish genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This is a DOK 2 because the student must recall the characteristics of fiction and be able to apply that knowledge to the passage to come to a conclusion.

Distractor Rationale

- A. There is no required length for fiction.
- B. All genres can use descriptive language.
- C. Correct. One characteristic of fiction is to have a conflict and for the conflict to be resolved.**
- D. All genres can include more than one setting.

2 Paragraphs 2 and 3 are mainly about

- A** how Charlie and the narrator first met in school.
- B** the narrator's feelings about his working relationship with Charlie.
- C** the responsibilities that Charlie and the narrator undertake on the project.
- D** Mr. Egan's reasons for why the narrator and Charlie are made partners on the project.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

7.2.R.1: Students will summarize alphabetic and/or multimodal texts, including main idea and key details, to demonstrate comprehension within and between texts.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must have a strong comprehension of paragraphs 2 and 3. The student identifies key ideas and draws meaning from those paragraphs to determine what they are mainly about.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Paragraph 2 mentions that Charlie and the narrator have known each other since kindergarten, but paragraph 3 mentions nothing about their history.
- B. Correct. Paragraphs 2 and 3 detail the narrator's negative past experiences working with Charlie and the narrator's relief that they would not have to work hand-in-hand on the book fair project.**
- C. Paragraph 3 details how the assignment is divided up between Charlie and the narrator, but paragraph 2 mentions nothing about the assignment.
- D. There is confusion expressed in paragraph 2 from the narrator in regards to why Mr. Egan put him and Charlie together on the project, but there is no evidence in these paragraphs about why Mr. Egan made that decision.

3 How is Mr. Egan important to the plot?

- A** He helps the narrator understand the value of cooperating with others.
- B** He provides the organizational skills needed for the narrator and Charlie to be successful.
- C** He serves as the adult sponsor if there are problems that the students cannot resolve themselves.
- D** He attempts to help the narrator and Charlie become friends by assigning them to work together.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

7.3.R.3: Students will analyze literary elements to support an interpretation of a text:

- setting
- plot
- characters (i.e., protagonist, antagonist)
- characterization
- conflict (i.e., internal, external)
- point of view (i.e., third person limited and omniscient and second person)

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must have a strong grasp of the passage and perform mental processing to understand the importance of a particular character in relation to the rest of the passage.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** At the end of the passage when the narrator questions Mr. Egan about his rationale for teaming the narrator and Charlie together, Mr. Egan replies that his intent was for the boys to see the importance of communication and working together.
- B.** Though Mr. Egan meets with Charlie and the narrator periodically about how their preparations are going, based on the passage he did not provide any strategies for their work. He left it all up to them.
- C.** Though Mr. Egan is the school sponsor of the book fair, there is no indication in the passage that he intervened when Charlie was unable to get his part of the project completed.
- D.** Though Mr. Egan paired the narrator and Charlie together, there is no indication in the passage that his motivation was to strengthen a friendship.

4 The author's use of hyperbole in paragraph 7 helps the reader understand

- A** where Charlie has to go.
- B** the extent of the problem.
- C** how the narrator is feeling.
- D** the satisfaction Charlie feels.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

7.3.R.4: Students will analyze literary devices to support an interpretation of a text:

- figurative language (i.e., simile, metaphor, personification, hyperbole, imagery, symbolism, idiom)
- sound devices (i.e., onomatopoeia, alliteration)
- verbal irony

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3. The item requires that the student have a strong grasp of paragraph 7. It also requires that the student know the meaning of hyperbole and why “a zillion” is an example of it. The student goes beyond the text to understand the effect of the word “a zillion” on the text.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The reference to Charlie being surrounded by “a zillion boxes of books” does not describe where Charlie has to go.
- B. Correct. The reference to Charlie being surrounded by “a zillion boxes of books” describes how overwhelmed Charlie appears in getting his part of the project finished.**
- C. The reference to Charlie being surrounded by “a zillion boxes of books” does not describe how the narrator is feeling.
- D. The reference to Charlie being surrounded by “a zillion boxes of books” does not describe the satisfaction that Charlie is feeling.

5 Using knowledge of word parts, what does unforeseeable mean?

- A** not able to see at all
- B** not able to see again
- C** not able to see ahead
- D** not able to see correctly

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

7.4.R.3: Students will use word parts (e.g., affixes, Greek roots, stems) to define and determine the meaning of increasingly complex words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to recall what the different word parts mean and apply that knowledge to determine the meaning of a particular word.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The word “foresee” means to be able to predict or be aware of beforehand, not to be unable see at all.
- B. The word “foresee” means to be able to predict or be aware of beforehand, not to be unable to see again.
- C. Correct. The word “foresee” means to be able to predict or be aware of beforehand, but the prefix “un” added to the word causes it to mean **not** able to see the future or be aware of beforehand.**
- D. The word “foresee” means to be able to predict or be aware of beforehand, not to be unable to see correctly.

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Wang Yani

by Amelie Welden



Wang Yani

- 1 Wang Shiqiang couldn't believe his eyes—his painting was ruined! And the culprit was his two-and-a-half-year-old daughter, Yani. She had gotten into his oil paints while he was gone and used them to create her own "masterpiece" right over her father's careful brush strokes. Wang Shiqiang was angry at first, but Yani explained, "Papa, I was helping you paint. I want to paint and paint." At that moment, Wang Shiqiang knew that his daughter's talent and desire would make her an amazing artist.
- 2 Wang Yani was born in Gongcheng, a small town in southern China. She expressed an interest in painting at a very young age, and her father, an art teacher and painter, gave her the materials she needed. By the time she was three years old, Yani had already created paintings in the bold dynamic style that would characterize all her work.
- 3 This young, inspired artist was only four years old when she held her first art exhibition in Shanghai. By age six, Yani had completed over four thousand paintings, and when she was eight, one of her paintings was made into a Chinese postage stamp.

- 4 Over the next few years, Yani's work was shown throughout Asia, Europe, and North America. Then, in 1989, she achieved something truly unheard of in the art world: at just fourteen years of age she became the youngest person ever to have a one-person show at the famous Smithsonian Institution in Washington, D.C. Her exhibition was called "Yani: The Brush of Innocence."
- 5 Amazingly, Yani has never had any formal art training or painting classes. She paints just because she loves it. Her painting has been called "fresh" and "vigorous." Although her style is unique, she paints with traditional Chinese materials: brushes, inks, pigments, and special paper. Yani relies on her memory of real life experiences for inspiration, but she also uses her imagination to bring the paintings to life.
- 6 Before starting a painting, Yani tries to clear her mind. Often she listens to music while she works—Beethoven's Fifth Symphony is her favorite. After deciding what to paint, Yani begins to work, sweeping her brush smoothly across the paper.
- 7 Usually it takes Yani about thirty or forty minutes to complete a painting. When she's done, she marks the painting with her personal red seal which, like a signature, identifies Yani as the artist.
- 8 Yani's favorite subjects in her early paintings were animals, especially cats and monkeys. She paints these animals playing and being mischievous. Yani's later work portrays landscapes and people, and many of her paintings tell a story. She often uses her art as a way to communicate. Once, to show her mom that she was hungry, Yani painted a picture of a monkey eating fruit.
- 9 Yani devotes a lot of her time to painting. Even when she was in school, Yani managed to paint about three pictures a day. But she also made time for her other hobbies and interests like singing, dancing, reading, writing, sports, and music. Yani's talent has brought her international acclaim, but it is her love for painting that inspires her to keep creating new work.

"Wang Yani" by Amelie Welden, from *Girls Who Rocked the World: Heroines from Sacagawea to Sheryl Swoopes*. Copyright © 1998 by Amelie Welden. Reprinted by permission of Beyond Words Publishing.

Wang Shiqiang, Wang Yani's father, gave up his career as an artist when Wang Yani was eight years old. He did not want her to be influenced by his style of painting. He was determined for her to develop her own style. In order to broaden her experience, he took her on tours to numerous countries. He felt that this experience would give her inspiration for her paintings.

Which statement is the **best** summary of the information above and the information from paragraph 2 of the passage?

- A** Wang Shiqiang wanted his daughter's art to be unique.
- B** Wang Shiqiang made sure that his daughter's art was similar to his.
- C** Wang Shiqiang felt that his daughter's art should reflect Chinese tradition.
- D** Wang Shiqiang thought his daughter's art should focus on Chinese sceneries.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

7.2.R.1: Students will summarize alphabetic and/or multimodal texts, including main idea and key details, to demonstrate comprehension within and between texts.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because the student must comprehend two different texts, identify key details and ideas, and synthesize those ideas to develop a summary.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** The paragraph in the stem states, "He did not want her to be influenced by his style of painting. He was determined for her to develop her own style." The passage states, ". . . her father, an art teacher and painter, gave her the materials she needed." These lines support the idea that Wang Yani's father wanted her art to be special.
- B.** The information in the texts makes it clear that Wang Shiqiang wanted his daughter's art to be unlike his own.
- C.** The information in the passage notes that Wang Yani used traditional Chinese materials, but both texts make it clear that Wang Shiqiang wanted his daughter's art to be her own.
- D.** The information in the passage notes that Wang Yani used traditional Chinese materials, but both texts make it clear that Wang Shiqiang wanted his daughter's art to reflect her own interests.

7 Which characteristic of the passage **best** classifies it as nonfiction?

- A** It uses specific vocabulary.
- B** It has organized paragraphs.
- C** It tells about the life of a real person.
- D** It contains a conflict and a resolution.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

7.2.R.2: Students will analyze details in fiction, poetry, and nonfiction texts to distinguish genres.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must understand the features of different genres and classify a text using that knowledge.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Specific vocabulary may be found in fiction and poetry.
- B. Fiction text is also organized into paragraphs.
- C. Correct. A key characteristic of nonfiction is that it is about something that exists and that has elements that can be verified.**
- D. Both fiction and nonfiction can contain a conflict and resolution.

A student is creating a paraphrase of paragraph 8. Drag two sentences into the boxes in the correct order to complete the paraphrase.

To drag a sentence click and hold the the sentence, and then drag it to the desired space. To change a sentence, click and hold it, and then drag it back to the original location.

Yani liked to paint animals acting silly.

Yani believed that monkeys were the most fun to paint.

Yani used her art to share her thoughts and feelings with others.

Once, Yani painted food to tell her mom she wanted something to eat.

Paraphrase of Paragraph 8
As a young painter, Yani enjoyed painting animals.
After painting for some time, Yani expanded her subjects to include people and nature.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

7.2.R.3: Students will paraphrase a short passage in their own words to demonstrate comprehension.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to comprehend the text and rephrase it while maintaining fidelity to the text.

Correct

Paraphrase of Paragraph 8
As a young painter, Yani enjoyed painting animals.
After painting for some time, Yani expanded her subjects to include people and nature.
Yani used her art to share her thoughts and feelings with others.
Once, Yani painted food to tell her mom she wanted something to eat.

Incorrect

Paraphrase of Paragraph 8
As a young painter, Yani enjoyed painting animals.
After painting for some time, Yani expanded her subjects to include people and nature.
Yani liked to paint animals as they rested in the wild.
Yani believed that monkeys were the most fun to paint.

Distractor Rationale

The student misunderstands the information in the paragraph and selects details that are not accurate for the paraphrase.

9 Which of the following is a paraphrase of paragraph 8?

- A** As a young painter, Yani enjoyed painting animals. After painting for some time, Yani expanded her subjects to include people and nature. Yani used her art to share her thoughts and feelings with others. Once, Yani painted food to tell her mom she wanted something to eat.
- B** As a young painter, Yani enjoyed painting animals. After painting for some time, Yani expanded her subjects to include people and nature. Cats and monkeys were Yani's favorite subjects to paint. Yani believed that monkeys were the most fun to paint.
- C** As a young painter, Yani enjoyed painting animals. After painting for some time, Yani expanded her subjects to include people and nature. Yani believed that monkeys were the most fun to paint. It was important to Yani that her paintings tell a story.
- D** As a young painter, Yani enjoyed painting animals. After painting for some time, Yani expanded her subjects to include people and nature. It was important to Yani that her paintings tell a story. Once, Yani painted food to tell her mom she wanted something to eat.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

7.2.R.3: Students will paraphrase a short passage in their own words to demonstrate comprehension.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to comprehend the text and rephrase it while maintaining fidelity to the text.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** This choice includes the key details in the correct order.
- B.** This choice includes a couple of key details, but others are unimportant or are in the wrong order.
- C.** This choice includes a couple of key details, but others are unimportant or are in the wrong order.
- D.** This choice includes a couple of key details, but others are unimportant or are in the wrong order.

- 10** There are many steps in the writing process. One of them is to revise a first draft. Explain why this step is an important part of the writing process.

Standard 2: Students will engage in a recursive process that may include prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing.

7.2.W.3: Students will routinely and recursively revise drafts for intended purpose, audience, organization, and coherence (e.g., consistent point of view).

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This is a DOK 3 because the student must explain the importance of a particular step in the context of an entire process.

Scoring:

Rubric

Score	Description
2	The response fulfills the requirements of the task by explaining why the revision of a first draft is an important step of the writing process.
1	The response fulfills some requirements of the task, but some of the information may lack specificity.
0	The response does not fulfill the requirements of the task. The response is incorrect, irrelevant, or missing.
Blank	no response

Sample Response

Possible responses include:

- It allows the writer to clarify ideas.
 - A first draft allows the writer to see where points/information are confusing and make changes.
- The writer is able to determine what additions (or subtractions) to make in the piece.
 - Once a draft has been written, the writer can review the document to see if information should be added to support the thesis or remove information that does not.
- The writer can verify if the purpose of the paper is met and adjust accordingly.
 - It is important to keep writing focused on the reason the paper is being written and if it has strayed, make changes.
- Revision allows the writer to make sure the point of view is consistent.

Other responses are acceptable if they are related to the reasons revision is an important step.

- 11** Which sentence from the passage contains an **opinion**?
- A** Wang Yani was born in Gongcheng, a small town in southern China.
 - B** Over the next few years, Yani’s work was shown throughout Asia, Europe, and North America.
 - C** Amazingly, Yani has never had any formal art training or painting classes.
 - D** Even when she was in school, Yani managed to paint about three pictures a day.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

7.3.R.6: Students will distinguish factual claims from opinions.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must classify text to determine which option is an opinion.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This sentence is a fact because it contains information that can be verified.
- B. This sentence is a fact because it contains information that can be verified.
- C. Correct.** It may not be “amazing” that Wang Yani does not have formal art training. This is a subjective claim.
- D. This sentence is a fact because it contains information that can be verified.

12 How does the sequential structure of paragraphs 2–4 **best** support the author’s purpose of informing readers about how Wang Yani’s talent became widely recognized?

- A** by sharing the name of Wang Yani’s exhibition
- B** by naming the town where Wang Yani was born
- C** by revealing the places Wang Yani exhibited her art
- D** by explaining that Wang Yani’s father gave her art supplies

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

7.3.R.7: Students will analyze how informational text structures support the author’s purpose:

- compare/contrast
- cause/effect
- problem/solution
- description
- sequential

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must understand what sequential structure is and apply that understanding to how the author uses it to provide information about the subject.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This information provides a single detail about Wang Yani but does not provide extended information about her early years as an artist.
- B. This information about Wang Yani does not tell the reader anything about her early years as an artist.
- C. Correct. The first four paragraphs tell about Wang Yani’s interest in painting and then name the different places she showed her art in chronological order.**
- D. This information shares how Wang Yani’s interest in art was supported by her father, but does not provide extended information about her early years as an artist.

13 In paragraph 1, what does **culprit** mean?

- A** genius
- B** painter
- C** offender
- D** youngster

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

7.4.R.2: Students will use context clues, connotation, and denotation to determine or clarify the meaning of words or distinguish among multiple-meaning words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must evaluate the surrounding text to determine the meaning of an unknown word.

Distractor Rationale

- A. A “culprit” is a person who does something wrong rather than “genius” which means to be exceptionally talented or gifted.
- B. A painter is a person who, in this context, uses paints to create art. It does not have the negative association the word “culprit” has.
- C. **Correct.** The first sentence of the paragraph states that a painting had been ruined. The second sentence says that the culprit, or offender responsible for the misdeed, was his daughter.
- D. A “youngster” is a young person or child, while a “culprit” is a person who does something wrong.

14 Complete the analogy.

Artist is to exhibition as **actor** is to _____ .

- A** play
- B** script
- C** costume
- D** audience

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

7.4.R.1: Students will analyze the relationships among synonyms, antonyms, and analogies.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must first determine the relationship between the first two terms and apply that information to complete the analogy.

Distractor Rationale

- A. **Correct.** The relationship in the first part of the analogy shows what an artist does after working on subjects. An actor performs in a play as the final step in an artistic process.
- B. A script is a tool used by an actor to prepare for the final product.
- C. A costume can function as a tool to support an actor in their role.
- D. The audience is the group of people who enjoy the final product, which in this case would be a play.

A student wrote a report on how people have made candles throughout history. Read the first part of the report, think about what suggestions you would make, and then answer the questions.

Making Candles—Part 1

1 Did you ever wonder who developed the first candles? Well, surprisingly, there is
2 no one clear answer, but it is known that candles have been around.
3 Early Egyptians **are** the first to use wickless candles where cloth was
4 soaked in an oily substance. Ancient Romans created candles with wicks by
5 dipping papyrus, a tall marsh plant, in beeswax over and over again. Historians
6 are certain that candles have been burning around the world for a very long time.
7 All candles are made from some type of **fat oil gel or waxy substance** that came
8 from either a plant, insect, or animal—and sometimes even from a rock. Colonial
9 women are known to have produced the first candles in the United States by
10 boiling berries from the bayberry bush. When burned, these berries have a sweet
11 smell which creates a clean, pleasant aroma in the room.

"Making Candles—Part 1." Copyright © 2022 by Cognia, Inc.

- 15** Where is the **best** place to add the prepositional phrase **for over 5,000 years** in lines 1 and 2?
- A** after the word “surprisingly”
 - B** after the word “answer”
 - C** after the word “known”
 - D** after the word “around”

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

7.5.R.2: Students will recognize and explain the impact on meaning of parts of speech in sentences:

- nouns
- gerunds
- subject and verb agreement
- cumulative and coordinate adjectives
- demonstrative pronouns
- vague pronouns (i.e., ones with unclear or ambiguous antecedents)
- singular *they/them/their*
- correlative conjunctions
- adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to understand the purpose of the prepositional phrase and apply that knowledge.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The prepositional phrase does modify an adverb, but not this adverb.
- B. The prepositional phrase does not modify this noun because it is an adverbial phrase.
- C. The prepositional phrase does not modify this verb.
- D. **Correct.** This prepositional phrase modifies the adverb “around” and should be placed after the adverb.

16 What change, if any, should be made to **are** in line 3?

- A** is
- B** was
- C** were
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to comprehend, analyze, and/or evaluate a variety of texts.

7.5.R.2: Students will recognize and explain the impact on meaning of parts of speech in sentences:

- nouns
- gerunds
- subject and verb agreement
- cumulative and coordinate adjectives
- demonstrative pronouns
- vague pronouns (i.e., ones with unclear or ambiguous antecedents)
- singular *they/them/their*
- correlative conjunctions
- adverbs
- interjections

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This is a DOK 1 because the student recalls subject-verb agreement.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is a singular present tense verb which is incorrect for subject and verb agreement in this sentence.
- B. This is singular past tense verb which is incorrect for subject and verb agreement in this sentence.
- C. Correct. The report is written in the past tense, and because the subject “Egyptians” is plural then the verb must be the plural past tense form “were” in order to have correct subject and verb agreement.**
- D. This is a plural present tense verb which is incorrect for subject and verb agreement in this sentence.

17 What change should be made to **fat oil gel or waxy substance** in line 7?

- A** fat: oil: gel: or waxy substance
- B** fat; oil; gel; or waxy substance
- C** fat, oil, gel, or waxy substance
- D** fat-oil-gel-or waxy substance

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

7.5.W.7: Students will use commas to separate words or phrases in a series.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student needs to apply their knowledge of conventions of standard American English.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Colons are used to give emphasis, present dialogue, introduce lists or texts, and to clarify titles. Colons are not used to separate items in a series.
- B. Semicolons are not used to separate items in a series.
- C. Correct. Commas are used to separate items in a series.**
- D. Hyphens are not used to separate items in a series.

Read the next part of the report, think about what suggestions you would make, and then answer the questions.

Making Candles—Part 2

12 This process proved to be too time-consuming, however, so other options were
13 developed to be more efficient. Beeswax became the most popular substance to
14 use in candle making. Paraffin wax is currently the most-used product in creating
15 candles. Beeswax is still used today.

16 Although there are several ways to make candles by using molds; most traditional
17 candles are made by one of two other methods. One method is to dip a wick
18 over and over in melted wax repeatedly until the desired thickness is achieved. The other
19 method is to use a sheet of softened wax and roll it tightly around a wick.

"Making Candles—Part 2." Copyright © 2022 by Cognia, Inc.

18 What change should be made to lines 14 and 15 to best combine these sentences into a compound sentence?

- A** Paraffin wax is currently the most-used product in creating candles since beeswax is still used today.
- B** Even though paraffin wax is currently the most-used product in creating candles, beeswax is still used today.
- C** Paraffin wax is currently the most-used product in creating candles while beeswax is still used today.
- D** Paraffin wax is currently the most-used product in creating candles, but beeswax is still used today.

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

7.5.W.1: Students will compose simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences to add clarity and variety in their writing.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must understand both sentences, know what a compound sentence is, and make the appropriate edit.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is a complex sentence with the wrong conjunction used in regards to the relationship of ideas being combined.
- B. This is a complex sentence.
- C. This is a complex sentence.
- D. Correct. The use of the conjunction “but” preceded by a comma combines these two sentences into a compound sentence.

19 What change, if any, should be made to the sentence in lines 16 and 17?

- A** Although there are several ways to make candles by using molds, most traditional candles are made by one of two other methods.
- B** Although there are several ways to make candles by using molds most traditional candles are made by one of two other methods.
- C** Although there are several ways to make candles by using molds: most traditional candles are made by one of two other methods.
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

7.5.W.1: Students will compose simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences to add clarity and variety in their writing.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student is applying punctuation to a complex sentence.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** The introductory dependent clause needs to be separated from the independent clause with a comma.
- B.** The introductory dependent clause needs to be separated from the independent clause with a comma because without the comma this is a run-on sentence.
- C.** The introductory dependent clause needs to be separated from the independent clause with a comma, not a colon.
- D.** The introductory dependent clause needs to be separated from the independent clause with a comma, not a semicolon.